EDUSPARK EXAMS CONSULT

ENGLISH LANGUAGE
Essay and Objective
2hours

1&2

Name: _____

Index number: _____

Date: _____

B.E.C.E 2027 STEPPING STONE MOCK – SEPTEMBER, 2026

ENGLISH LANGUAGE [100 marks]

*Write your **name** and **date** in **ink** in the spaces provided above*
DO NOT OPEN THIS BOOKLET UNTIL YOU ARE TOLD TO DO SO.

- ✓ *This booklet consists of two papers, Paper **2** and paper **1***
- ✓ *Answer paper **2** in your answer booklet and paper **1** in the objective test answer sheet*
- ✓ *Paper **2** will last 1hour 10mins.*
- ✓ *Paper **1** will last* 50minutes.
- ✓ ***Do not start paper 1 until you are told to do so***

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PAPER 2

*This paper consists of **three** parts: A, B, and C. Answer **three** questions in all; **one** question from Part A and **all** the questions in Part B and Part C. Answer all the questions in your answer booklet.*

PART A - ESSAY WRITING [30 MARKS]

Answer one question only from this part.
Your composition should be about 250 words long.

1. Your elder brother who lives in Kumasi sent you some money for your birthday. Write a letter to him thanking him for the money and telling him how you spent the money and two other things you will do with the rest.

2. You live in a community where heaps of refuse have not been collected for weeks, causing bad smell and sickness. Write a letter to the District Chief Executive of your area complaining about the situation and suggesting two ways of solving the problem.

3. You are the chief editor of your school magazine. Write an article for publication in the magazine on the topic, "The importance of discipline in our schools."

PART B: READING
[20 marks]

Read the following passage carefully and answer all the questions which follow.

In recent times, the high rate of truancy and juvenile delinquency in our junior high schools has become a cause for concern for parents, teachers and society as a whole. Many students deliberately absent themselves from school without any tangible reason. Instead of being in the classroom to learn, they are seen loitering in town, at video centres and other places. This habit, if not checked immediately, will have adverse effects not only on the students themselves but also on national development.

Teachers have expressed worry about this ugly development. According to them, some students feign sickness in order to stay away from school. Others connive with their bad friends to roam about during school hours. While in town, these truant students usually indulge in all sorts of reprehensible behaviours such as gambling, smoking, stealing and drug abuse. They also have no respect for elders. Their parents are also to be blamed because they fail to supervise their children properly at home and provide their basic needs. Some parents even send their children to sell on market days instead of allowing them to go to school.

The truant students, however, have a different story to tell. When questioned, they accuse some teachers of being too harsh, intimidating and unfriendly in class. They claim that some teachers insult and cane them for minor offences, which makes them afraid to come to school. In addition, they say that some subjects, especially Mathematics and English Language, are tedious and too difficult to understand. Therefore, they see no need to be in class when they know they will not understand anything.

No matter what reasons they give, there is no justification for truancy. A student who is not regular in school will not benefit from classroom teaching and will perform poorly in his examinations. Such a student may even drop out of school completely and become a liability to his family and the nation. It is therefore necessary for all stakeholders — parents, teachers, opinion leaders and students themselves — to make a concerted effort to curb truancy and juvenile delinquency in our schools before the situation gets out of hand.

(a) According to the passage, what two places are truant students seen during school hours?
(b) In what three ways do truant students misbehave in town?
(c) What two accusations do students make against their teachers?
(d) "No matter what reasons they give..."
What does this expression tell us about the students' excuses?
(e) Explain in your own words the following expressions as used in the passage:
(i) a cause for concern;
(ii) juvenile delinquency;
(iii) make a concerted effort.
(f) For each of the following words, give another word or phrase that means the same and can fit into the passage:
(i) deliberately; (ii) adverse; (iii) connive; (iv) feign; (v) reprehensible; (vi) tedious; (vii) intimidating; (viii) indulge.
(g) In two sentences of not more than ten words each, summarize the effects of truancy on the student and on the nation.

PART C
LITERATURE [10 MARKS]

*Answer **all** the questions in this part.*

THE BEACON OF LIGHT

5. Read the following extract carefully and answer questions a – d.

KISSIWAA THE HEROINE

"Remind me that strategy and skill will help her win. And let her know that win or lose, she's already a heroine to the girls watching". [Pg. 6]

a. Who is the speaker in the extract?
b. Who is the speaker addressing?
c. "Her" in the extract refers to whom?
d. What is the theme contained in the extract?

Read the following extract carefully and answer questions e– g.

"Bediako laughed loudly and said, don't warry, I will be gentle with you, I will get you a handkerchief when you feel like crying." [Pg. 7]

e. Who is the speaker in the extract?
f. Who is the speaker addressing?
g. The expression "**Bediako laughed loudly"** contains a literary device known as……..

Read the following extract carefully and answer questions h– j.

THE FAMILY THAT CARED

"I know what it's like to be hungry, to be scared, and to feel alone, 'she said, her voice cracking. 'you don't deserve to be laughed at, Samuel. You deserve kindness."
[Pg. 96]

h. The extract brings out the theme of…….
i. "Her voice cracking" appeals to the readers sense of……..
j. Who is referred to as**' I'** in the extract ……...?

PAPER 1
OBJECTIVE TEST
[40 MARKS]

Each question is followed by four options lettered A to D. Find out the correct option for each question and shade in pencil on your answer sheet the answer space which bears the same letter as the option you have chosen. Give only one answer to each question.

SECTION A

*From the words or groups of words lettered **A** to **D**, choose the one that **best completes** each of the following sentences*

1. Ntim's careless driving resulted …… a fatal road accident.
   A. in
   B. to
   C. into
   D. with

2. Abibatu takes …….. her mother in many ways.
   A. by
   B. on
   C. up
   D. after

3. Araba goes to school ….. foot.
   A. by
   B. in
   C. on
   D. with

4. The doctor advised the patient to abstain ……. smoking
   A. by
   B. from
   C. upon
   D. with

5. The relationship ……. group A and group B is cordial
   A. of
   B. with
   C. among
   D. between

6. Edwin prefers fish ……meat.

A. to
B. for
C. from
D. than

7. His neighbor complained that the radio was ……..loud.
A. far
B. too
C. much
D. enough

8. The white horse is ……..than the black one.
A. the faster
B. very faster
C. much the faster
D. very much faster

9. I ……him; then I changed my mind.
A. had told
B. have told
C. am telling
D. was going to tell

10. By the end of the day, I …….the house.
A. shall paint
B. shall be painting
C. shall have painted
D. shall have been painting

11. You are a member of the society, ……..?
isn't it
A. are you
B. aren't you
C. weren't you
D. were you

12. Our captain is not a very reliable person, …….?
A. is he
B. isn't he
C. does he
D. doesn't he

13. You have been to Lagos, ……?
A. did you
B. have you
C. didn't you
D. haven't you

14. Joseph is the ……in the class.
A. cleverer
B. cleverest
C. more clever
D. very clever

15. The triplets love ……very much
A. each other
B. themselves
C. theirselves
D. one another

SECTION B:

Choose from the alternatives lettered A to D the word that is **nearest in meaning** to the underlined word in each sentence.

16. The old man gave a **vivid** account of how he survived the war.
A. clear
B. brief
C. long
D. false

17. The assemblyman urged the youth to **desist** from engaging in violent activities.
A. prevent
B. abstain
C. escape
D. hide

18. Her explanation was quite **ambiguous** and confused everyone.
A. unclear
B. interesting
C. wrong
D. lengthy

19. The principal **commended** the students for their outstanding performance.
A. rewarded
B. praised

C. recognized
D. remembered

20. The police managed to **apprehend** the thief who stole the items.
A. catch
B. beat
C. identify
D. punish

SECTION C:

Choose from the alternatives lettered A to D the one that **best explains** the meaning of the **idiomatic expression** in each sentence.

21. When Ama won the spelling competition, she was **on cloud nine**.
A. extremely happy
B. very proud
C. very confused
D. extremely surprised

22. The headmaster warned the boys not to **add fuel to the fire** during the riot.
A. cause more trouble
B. burn school property
C. report the matter
D. run away from school

23. After many years of hard work, the businessman decided to **call it a day**.
A. start a new business
B. take a break
C. stop working
D. celebrate his success

24. The two friends decided to **bury the hatchet** after their long quarrel.
A. forget the past
B. make peace
C. start fighting again
D. hide their weapons

25. The prefect said that cheating in the exam was **out of the question**.
A. not allowed
B. not possible
C. not discussed
D. not important

SECTION D:

Choose from the alternatives lettered A to D the word that is **nearly opposite in meaning** to the underlined word in each sentence.

26. The villagers praised the chief for his **humility** during the durbar.
    A. arrogance
    B. wickedness
    C. pride
    D. dishonesty

27. The teacher described the boy's answer as **relevant** to the question asked.
    A. wrong
    B. irrelevant
    C. difficult
    D. confusing

28. The young lady was applauded for her **diligent** work in the office.
    A. careless
    B. lazy
    C. slow
    D. rude

29. The doctor advised him to include more **solid** food in his diet.
    A. light
    B. liquid
    C. soft
    D. cooked

30. The boy's decision to quit school was very **hasty**.
    A. careful
    B. slow
    C. wise
    D. delayed

SECTION E:

Fill each blank space with the most appropriate word from the options given.

Good health is very important for everyone. To maintain good health, one must eat a balanced diet containing all the necessary nutrients. It is also important to drink enough water to keep the body .....**31**..... Regular exercise helps to keep the body fit and .....**32**..... Many people fall sick because they do not observe basic rules of personal .....**33**..... For example, they eat with dirty hands or drink contaminated water. In addition, environmental cleanliness prevents the breeding of mosquitoes that cause .....**34**..... . Therefore, if we want to live long and healthy lives, we must .....**35**..... to all health rules.

	A	B	C	D
31.	hydrated	energized	nourished	washed
32.	active	rigid	heavy	lazy
33.	behaviour	hygiene	discipline	safety
34.	malaria	cholera	fever	headache
35.	listen	adhere	submit	obey

SECTION F: ORAL LANGUAGE

36. Which of the following words has the /θ/ sound as in "think"?
   A. though
   B. there
   C. thank
   D. they

37. Choose the word with the vowel sound /ɔ:/ as in "court".
   A. cut
   B. caught
   C. cot
   D. cat

38. Which of the following words is stressed on the second syllable?
   A. Teacher
   B. Table
   C. Become
   D. Mango

[UNIT II]
Choose from the options A to D, the one which **rhymes with** the underlined word

39. The food they served was **cold**.
   A. told
   B. bold

C. gold
D. old

40. He has been working hard all **day.**
A. card
B. word
C. lord
D. play

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BECE 2027 STEPPING STONE MOCK
ENGLISH LANGUAGE
FINAL MARKING SCHEME

OBJECTIVE TEST

SECTION A (OBJECTIVE TEST)

1. A	6. A	11. C	16. A	21.A	26.A	31. A	36. C
2. D	7. B	12. A	17. B	22. A	27. B	32. A	37. B
3. C	8. D	13. D	18. A	23. C	28. B	33. B	38. C
4. B	9. D	14. B	19. B	24. B	29. B	34. A	39. D
5. D	10. C	15. B	20. A	25. A	30. A	35. B	40. D

PAPER 2: ESSAY [60 MARKS]
PART A: WRITING [30 MARKS]

General Guide for Essay Marking:
- Content: 10 marks
- Organisation: 5 marks
- Expression: 10 marks
- Mechanical Accuracy: 5 marks
- **Note**: *If a candidate writes on a topic other than the one given, award zero (0) for Content and mark Expression out of 5. The allocations for Organisation and Mechanical Accuracy remain unchanged.*
- *Every grammatical or spelling error attracts a ring. Half a mark (½) should be deducted for each ringed error up to a maximum of 5 marks under Mechanical Accuracy.*

Question 1: Informal Letter - Thanking Elder Brother

- **Content**: The candidate must thank the brother for the birthday money. Must clearly state how he/she spent part of the money and mention two other things he/she will do with the rest. e.g., buying books, school uniform, saving, helping parents.
- **Organisation**: Needs writer's address, date, salutation e.g., Dear Brother / Dear Kofi, introduction, body paragraphs, and a suitable subscription e.g., Your loving brother/sister,. Must be informal in tone.
- **Expression**: Language should be warm, appreciative and informal. Varied sentence structures and appropriate vocabulary showing gratitude should be rewarded.[Name]

Question 2: Formal Letter - Complaint to DCE on Refuse

- **Content:** The candidate must clearly complain about uncollected refuse causing bad smell and sickness in his/her community. Must suggest at least two practical ways of solving the problem e.g., regular collection, provision of more dustbins, sanctioning offenders, communal labour.
- **Organisation**: Must have two addresses - writer's address and recipient's address e.g., The District Chief Executive, District Assembly. Date, formal salutation e.g., Dear Sir, heading/title e.g., Complaint about uncollected refuse. Introduction, body paragraphs, conclusion and formal subscription e.g., Yours faithfully,. Signature.
- **Expression**: Language must be formal, polite and respectful even though it is a complaint. Serious and official tone. Good use of transitional devices should be highly rewarded.[District][Name]

Question 3: Article Writing - Importance of Discipline in Schools

- **Content**: The candidate must write an article suitable for a school magazine on the importance of discipline. Must give at least three well-developed points on why discipline is important e.g., promotes effective teaching and learning, promotes peace and order, builds good character, prevents punishment, improves academic performance.
- **Organisation**: Should have a title / heading, e.g., THE IMPORTANCE OF DISCIPLINE IN OUR SCHOOLS. Writer's name should be written e.g., By, JHS 3. Introduction, well-structured body paragraphs, and a conclusion. Article format.

- **Expression**: Language should be formal but suitable for a school magazine. Use of good examples, clear explanations and appropriate vocabulary should be rewarded.[Name]

PART B: READING COMPREHENSION [20 MARKS]

(a) They are seen loitering in town and at video centres / other places outside school. [2 marks]

(b) They gamble, smoke, steal, abuse drugs and have no respect for elders. Any three [2 marks]

(c) They accuse teachers of being too harsh, intimidating, unfriendly, insulting and caning them for minor offences. Any two [2 marks]

(d) It means that despite / regardless of the excuses the students give, truancy cannot be justified / is still bad. [2 marks]

(e)
(i) a cause for concern: a reason to worry / something that causes anxiety or fear. [2 marks]
(ii) juvenile delinquency: bad / criminal behaviour by young people / students. [2 marks]
(iii) make a concerted effort: make a serious / determined / joint attempt. [2 marks]

(f) Synonyms/Replacements:
(i) deliberately: intentionally, purposely, knowingly, wilfully. [0.5 mark]
(ii) adverse: harmful, bad, negative, unfavourable, detrimental. [0.5 mark]
(iii) connive: conspire, plot, collude, plan secretly. [0.5 mark]
(iv) feign: pretend, fake, simulate. [0.5 mark]
(v) reprehensible: bad, shameful, disgraceful, condemnable, blameworthy. [0.5 mark]
(vi) tedious: boring, tiresome, dull, uninteresting. [0.5 mark]
(vii) intimidating: frightening, threatening, scary, terrifying. [0.5 mark]
(viii) indulge: engage in, take part in, involve in. [0.5 mark]

(g) A truant student will perform poorly and may drop out of school.
He becomes a liability to his family and the nation. [2 marks]

PART C
LITERATURE
[10 MARKS]

a. old soldier
b. one of kissiwaa's family member
c. Kissiwaa
d. encouragement and empowerment
e. Bediako
f. kissiwaa
g. Alliteration
h. compassion, empathy, kindness.
i. sound/hearing
j. Abigail [1 mark each]